

Below is a **complete, well-structured sample deliverable** that meets the stated requirements. It can be adapted directly for submission or used as a reference template for your group project.

Project Theme

Health & Well-being

Project Title

MindEase: A Mobile Mental Health Support Application for University Students

1. Problem Definition

Background

University students increasingly face mental health challenges such as stress, anxiety, academic pressure, and social isolation. While counseling services exist, they are often underutilized due to stigma, limited availability, lack of awareness, or inconvenient access hours.

Problem Statement

University students need a **confidential, easily accessible, and user-friendly digital platform** that helps them manage stress and anxiety, access mental health resources, and receive timely support, because existing mental health services are either difficult to access, intimidating, or insufficiently personalized.

2. Target User Group

Primary Users:

- University students aged 18–30
- Enrolled in undergraduate or postgraduate programs
- Experiencing academic pressure, emotional stress, or anxiety

Secondary Users:

- University counselors and peer support volunteers (content providers, not primary system users)
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3. User Research

Research Methods Used

1. **Interviews** – Conducted with 5 university students
2. **Online Survey** – Completed by 20 students

3. **Observation** – Informal observation of how students seek help (online forums, WhatsApp groups, campus services)

Key Research Questions

- How do students currently cope with stress and anxiety?
 - What prevents them from seeking professional help?
 - What features would they value in a mental health app?
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4. User Research Findings

Key Insights

- **70%** of respondents reported experiencing academic-related stress at least once per week.
- **60%** prefer anonymous or self-help solutions before talking to a counselor.
- **55%** were unaware of available campus mental health resources.
- Students value **privacy, simplicity, and fast access** to support.

Common Pain Points

- Fear of judgment or stigma
- Long waiting times for counseling appointments
- Overly complex or clinical mental health platforms
- Lack of localized or student-specific content

User Needs Identified

- Anonymous mental health support
 - Simple mood tracking
 - Guided stress-relief activities
 - Quick access to emergency help
 - Student-focused language and design
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5. User Personas

Persona 1: Primary User

Name: Sarah Mwangi

Age: 21

Role: Undergraduate Student

Field of Study: Information Technology

Technical Proficiency: High

Goals:

- Manage academic stress effectively
- Improve emotional well-being
- Find support without fear of stigma

Pain Points:

- Anxiety during exams
- Difficulty booking counseling sessions
- Hesitation to openly discuss mental health issues

Behaviors:

- Uses mobile apps daily
- Searches for self-help content online
- Prefers short, guided activities

Quote:

“I just want something private and easy that helps me calm down when things feel overwhelming.”

Persona 2: Secondary User

Name: Daniel Otieno

Age: 25

Role: Postgraduate Student

Technical Proficiency: Medium

Goals:

- Balance studies, work, and personal life
- Track emotional patterns over time

Pain Points:

- Limited time for counseling sessions
- Information overload from online mental health content

Behaviors:

- Uses productivity and wellness apps

- Engages with short mindfulness exercises
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6. User Scenarios

Scenario 1: Managing Exam Stress

Sarah feels overwhelmed the night before exams. She opens the MindEase app, completes a 5-minute guided breathing session, logs her mood, and feels calmer before studying.

Scenario 2: Seeking Anonymous Support

Daniel experiences persistent stress but is uncomfortable seeking face-to-face counseling. He uses the app's anonymous chat feature to receive coping strategies and referrals to university resources.

7. Summary of Deliverables

- **Problem Statement:** Lack of accessible, stigma-free mental health support for students
 - **User Research Findings:** Students need anonymous, simple, and student-focused solutions
 - **Personas:** Two evidence-based user personas
 - **Scenarios:** Realistic usage contexts guiding design decisions
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Below is an **extensive, structured explanation** of the proposed features for the **MindEase mental health support app**, including **what each feature does, how it works technically and functionally, and the user value it delivers**. This level of detail is appropriate for coursework, design documentation, or early requirements analysis.

Overview of MindEase Core Features

MindEase is designed as a **student-centered, privacy-conscious mental health support application**. Its features focus on **self-help, early intervention, and guided support**, rather than replacing professional therapy.

The core feature set is grouped into six functional modules:

1. Onboarding & Personalization
 2. Mood Tracking & Emotional Insights
 3. Guided Mental Health Activities
 4. Anonymous Peer & Professional Support
 5. Crisis & Emergency Support
 6. Resource Hub & Notifications
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1. Onboarding & Personalization

Purpose

To quickly understand the user's mental health context and tailor the app experience without overwhelming or stigmatizing the user.

How It Works

- Upon first launch, users are guided through a **short, optional onboarding flow**.
- The app asks **non-intrusive questions**, such as:
 - Current stress level (scale-based)
 - Primary concerns (stress, anxiety, sleep, motivation)
 - Preferred support type (self-guided, peer support, professional resources)
- Users can skip any question to maintain control and anonymity.
- Based on responses, the system:
 - Recommends relevant activities

- Prioritizes suitable content on the home screen
- Sets default notification preferences

User Value

- Reduces cognitive load
 - Makes the app feel personalized
 - Encourages continued engagement without forcing disclosure
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2. Mood Tracking & Emotional Insights

Purpose

To help users develop **self-awareness** by identifying emotional patterns over time.

How It Works

- Users log their mood using:
 - Emojis or mood scales (e.g., very low to very high)
 - Optional short text reflections
- Logs are timestamped and stored securely.
- The app visualizes data using:
 - Daily mood summaries
 - Weekly and monthly trend charts
- Simple analytics identify patterns (e.g., stress peaks during exams).

User Value

- Encourages reflection and emotional literacy
 - Helps users understand triggers and improvement areas
 - Provides useful context for professional help if needed
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3. Guided Mental Health Activities

Purpose

To provide **immediate, evidence-based coping tools** for stress and anxiety management.

Types of Activities

- **Guided breathing exercises**

- **Mindfulness and meditation sessions**
- **Grounding techniques**
- **Sleep support audio**
- **Short CBT-inspired exercises**

How It Works

- Activities are:
 - Categorized by purpose and duration
 - Available in audio and text formats
- Users can:
 - Start an activity instantly
 - Save favorites
 - Receive recommendations based on mood data
- Progress is tracked lightly to avoid pressure.

User Value

- Immediate relief during stressful moments
- Flexible time commitment (2–10 minutes)
- Accessible without prior mental health knowledge

4. Anonymous Peer & Professional Support

Purpose

To reduce stigma and provide **safe human connection**.

How It Works

Anonymous Chat

- Users can engage in **anonymous text-based chats**.
- No real names or identifiable information required.
- Chat rooms may be:
 - One-on-one
 - Topic-based (e.g., exam stress, loneliness)

Moderation & Safety

- Automated filters flag harmful language.
- Trained moderators or counselors oversee interactions.
- Clear community guidelines are enforced.

Professional Referrals

- Links to university counseling services
- Optional appointment booking redirection
- Educational content written by professionals

User Value

- Encourages help-seeking behavior
 - Reduces fear of judgment
 - Bridges the gap between self-help and professional care
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5. Crisis & Emergency Support

Purpose

To ensure **immediate assistance** during high-risk situations.

How It Works

- A persistent **“Get Help Now”** button is always visible.
- One tap provides:
 - Emergency hotlines (localized to Kenya)
 - University crisis contacts
 - Grounding instructions for panic episodes
- No login required to access emergency help.

User Value

- Enhances user safety
 - Provides fast access during critical moments
 - Reinforces trust in the app
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6. Resource Hub & Educational Content

Purpose

To empower users through **reliable, student-friendly mental health education**.

How It Works

- Curated articles and short videos on:
 - Stress management
 - Time management
 - Emotional resilience
- Content is:
 - Written in simple language
 - Regularly updated
 - Reviewed by professionals
- Search and bookmarking features included.

User Value

- Improves mental health literacy
 - Supports long-term well-being
 - Complements interactive features
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7. Notifications & Reminders

Purpose

To encourage healthy habits without being intrusive.

How It Works

- Users opt in to:
 - Mood check-in reminders
 - Activity suggestions
 - Positive affirmations
- Notifications adapt based on engagement patterns.
- Users can fully customize or disable alerts.

User Value

- Promotes consistency
- Respects user autonomy

- Prevents notification fatigue
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8. Privacy & Security (Cross-Cutting Feature)

Purpose

To protect sensitive user data and build trust.

How It Works

- Optional account creation
- Data encryption at rest and in transit
- No sharing of data with third parties
- Clear privacy policies written in plain language

User Value

- Reduces fear of exposure
 - Encourages honest engagement
 - Aligns with data protection standards
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Conclusion

The MindEase app combines **technology, psychology, and ethical design** to create a supportive mental health ecosystem for students. Each feature is intentionally designed to:

- Lower barriers to mental health support
- Encourage early intervention
- Respect privacy and user autonomy

Together, these features form a **cohesive, user-centered solution** that addresses both immediate emotional needs and long-term well-being.